ENCOUNTERS

Ssisssuraaaaggg

Enormous snake, ringed in crimson and black bands, demonic horn in centre of fanged head.

Level 4 | hp 20 | Saves 13 | Defence 1
Mov A | Morale 18 | Reptilian Demon
- **Bite:** TH5, DMG 2.

Living Bones

Living dead that can no longer form a cohesive skeleton body. Skulls can still bite.

Level 1 | hp 2 | Saves 4 | Defence 0
Mov S | Morale 15 | Undead
- **Bite:** TH4, DMG 2.

Crystal Prisoner

Slow moving man-shaped, sparkling crystal body.

Level 2 | hp 8 | Saves 7 | Defence 0
Mov S | Morale 6 | Undead
- **Fist:** TH 4, DMG 3.

Clay Soldier

Animated, red clay soldier/general/warlord.

Level 2 | hp 9 | Saves 7 | Defence 0
Mov S | Morale 18 | Construct
- **Spear:** TH5, DMG 3

ITEMS AND SPELLS



Demon's horn: Cast **Invoke Ssisssuraaaaggg** once per day. Mark usage each time a Shadow Snake is summoned.



Wizard's Globe: (200 coins). INT save to learn to use. Then can cast The Eye using up to 3 DICE. 50% chance that alien face looks back and forces CHA save or take drained condition.



Brass-bound tome: INT save to read spell and then can roll for a new random spell to add to spell book.

Spell: Invoke Ssisssuraaaaggg
[SUM] of 5 or less: caster suffers **patron taint**.
[SUM] 6-9: the demon ignores you.
[SUM] 10-13: the demon hears you. +1 to next attack
[SUM] 14- 16 A **shadow snake** springs from the **Demon's Horn** and attacks nearest creature in sight for 1d4 rounds.
[SUM]= 17+ As above, but the snake remains for 1d4+1 rounds and the PC can direct the snake to a specific target.
Shadow Snake: Level 3 hp 10, bite TH4 DMG 1 ignores Defence, can only be hit with magical weapons.
Patron Taint: (1d4)
1. **Handle Poison:** 1/day create a poison that kills.
2.**Barbed flesh**: +1 Defence, DMG to anyone grappling
3.**Mission**: undertake a mission for the demon
4.**Horned**: Caster grows a horn. TH4 DMG 2

When the Hollow Star rises, three leaning stones by the old mounds open onto a stone corridor and the tomb of an ancient war-wizard. Old Man Bob says he saw jewels, fine spears and enamelled armour in there fifty winters ago, but he had to run from the iron men.

This is an adventure for 4 to 6 level 1 PCs.

Each PC will also need to have recruited a hireling. Since the PCs will not have the funds to pay the hireling fee in advance, the hirelings are engaged on the basis that they will be paid their usual per session fee at the end of the adventure.

ADVENTURE HOOK

This year's winter was hard on your friend Old Man Bob. When you visited his bedside at the end, he spoke in laboured breaths of constellations not seen since he was a lad. The last time the Hollow Star had risen in the sky was two scor and ten years ago, he said. Under that strange star's light a magical door had opened by the old stone mounds. He'd seen jewels in there and fine weapons and ornate black armor, but he'd run when men made of iron had attacked. Now, old and dying, he wished he'd taken the chance on a life of adventure.

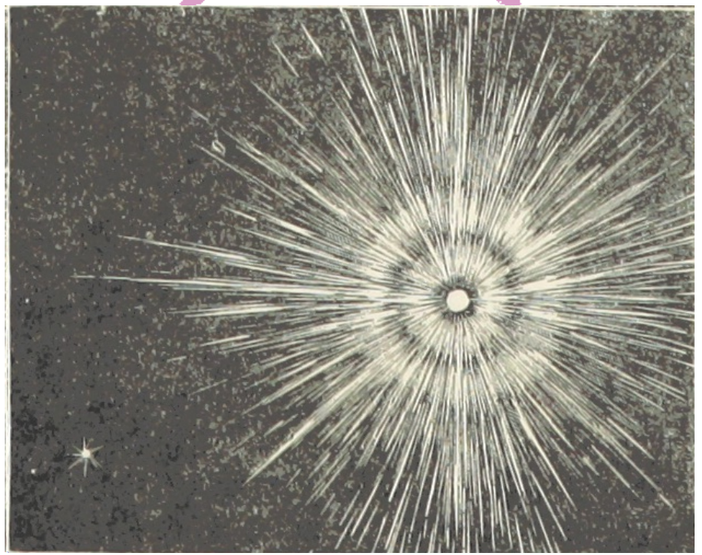
Tonight the Hollow Star rises again. Tonight you are taking the chance that Old Man Bob did not. You stand before the monolithic rocks of the old stone mounds, under a clear sky with the Hollow Star shining bright above you.

Three of the large stone blocks lean haphazardly together to form a man-sized upright rectangular doorway. As the Hollow Star climbs to its zentih, its light catches in the doorway, and a shimmering stone-lined corridor is visible through the stones, but only from one side of the opening. You step through the doorway with thoughts of jewels and adventure spurring you on.

A magical doorway to a treasure filled tomb that opens once every fifty years...

THE DOOR BENEATH THE FIRMAMENT

A conversion by Reuben Taylor



1: Doorway Beneath the Firmament

Starlight reveals a stone corridor, visible from the front only. It dead-ends at an iron door inlaid with jewelled stars.

- **Door.** Opens easily for one turn once the sky matches the stars on it: twelve turns' wait, INT save to realise (two usage on lit torches). Otherwise locked (STR save to break, or DEX save with thieves' tools).
- **Trap.** Forcing the door sears the lead character with fire (DEX save or 3 DMG; INT save at disadvantage to spot).

2: Guardian Hall

Four iron statues in black enamelled scale armour aiming spears at the door you came through.

- **Trap.** When two characters are inside or the far door is touched, they throw once and freeze: four spears, TH 4, DMG 3 (+1 TH in the doorway line).
- **Treasure.** Each suit is Light Armour, worth 160 coins. Four Spears (TH 5, DMG 4). Weapons that strike a statue mark 1 usage.

3: Monument Hall

A thirty-foot granite barbarian points at you from the far end, a grimoire and broadsword at its hip. A door in every wall.

- **Statue:** rotates to track characters, arm always pointing at largest group.
- **Floor:** fine scorch marks can be noticed on the floor by those who look.
- **Trap:** If anyone tries to leave the room, the statue shoots a fire jet (TH 6, DMG 2; ablaze, 2 DMG a round from fire, DEX save with advantage to put out, armour of no effect). One jet a round for five rounds.
- **Doors:** unlocked.

4: Scrying Chamber

A stone throne, walls hung with clay tablets. A fat snake ringed in red, a demon's horn between its eyes, hisses "I am Ssisssuraaaaggg, and you intrude on my guardianship."

- **Tablets.** A turn's reading: aliens from the stars gave a barbarian tribe magic, and will return when the stars are right.
- **Throne.** With the door shut, its back shows drifting unknown stars. A Wizard seated here may spend 3+ mana to scry any place they know.
- **Ssisssuraaaagg:** Enormous demonic snake, ringed in crimson and black bands, horn in centre of fanged head. When dead, it dissolves to ash, leaving only the **Demon's Horn** behind.

5: Chieftain's Burial

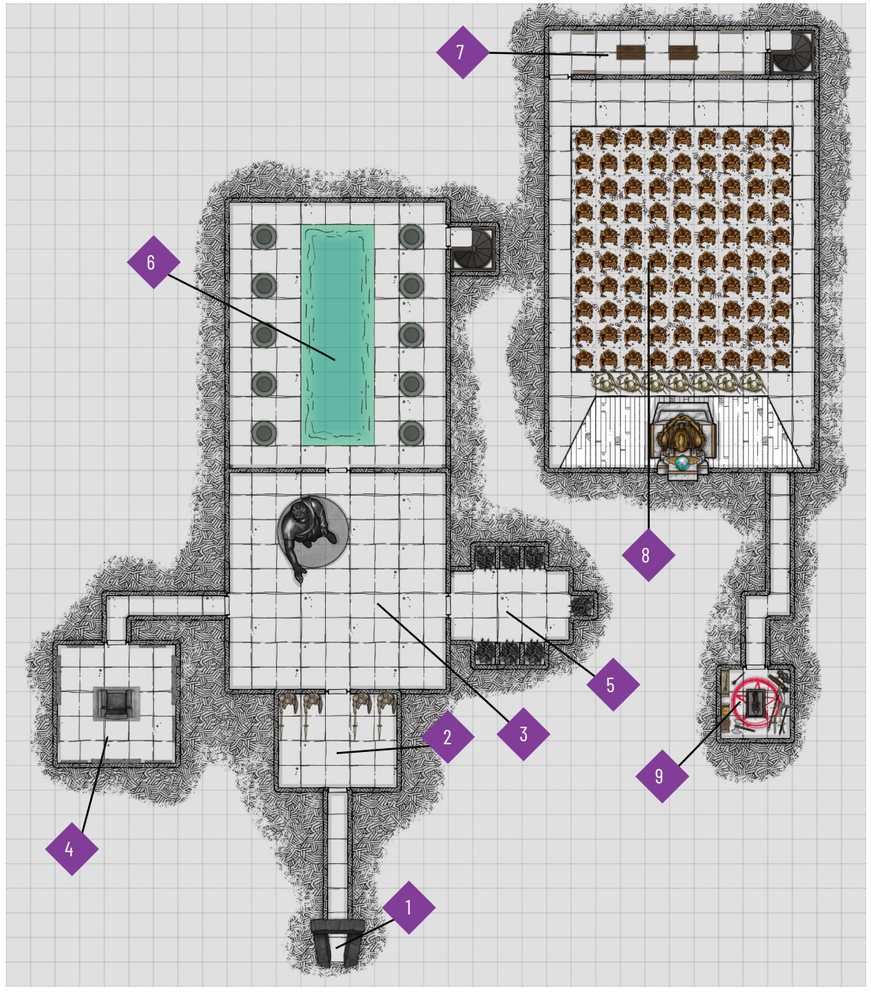
Seven alcoves of loose bones with funeral masks below the skulls. The limbs are too thick, the brows too heavy. They rattle but cannot rise. Only the Skulls can attack.

- **Living bones** (7). Each skull is bound to one clay generals in Area 8; destroying a skull here destroys a general in Area A.
- **Treasure**. Hand axe, battle axe, chain mail (Light Armour). All worn: two usage dots already marked.

RUNNING WITH LEVEL 0 CHARACTERS

This adventure can be run as a DCC-type funnel using the *Funnels for Flail* pamphlet by Verdant Core which contains the rules for generating level 0 characters, including their former occupations.

https://verdant-core.itch.io/funnels-for-flail



6: Gazing Pool

Enormous chamber. A glowing pool, three feet deep, fills the hall. Crystal figures shuffle toward your light. Door int he far corner

- **Crystal prisoners** (6). Attracted to light. If they reach light they stand still and soak up warmth. They fight only if harmed or blocked.
- **Pool:** 3' deep. pitch black bottom encrusted with shining crystals forming a constallation.
- **Treasure**. Star crystals on the pool floor: 1 coin each, five per turn per character. Roll a d6 for the tool each turn; 4-6 marks usage.
- **Drain**. Removing a crystal causes water to drain into Area 8 and air bubbles to rise. At 10 crystals the pool visibly drains. At 50 the floor buckles. At 100 the floor collapses into Area 8 (anyone in pool must make a DEX save or take 3 damage in the fall).
- **Door**: A far-corner door leads to a spiral stair down.

7: Strategy Room

Long, narrow. Door in the far wall. Ledges holding minature soldiers. Two tables with opposign armies laid out around buildings and hills.

- **Toy Soldiers.** Made of clay.
- **Toy Generals (2)**. Under the clay, the general of each army is a solid silver figuarine (20 coins each).
- **Door**: A far-corner door is unlocked.

8: Clay Army

Enormous three-tiered chamber with a ceiling studded with Star Crystals. A clay warlord on an oversized throne at the centre of a raised dais. A crystal globe pulses above him. Seven clay generals beneath the dias at ground level. Seventy life-size clay soldiers in a pit below them. The warlord jerks an arm, and the army takes a single step forward.

- **Generals.** Each skull smashed in Area 5 shatters a general. If all generals are destroyed, the soldiers mill about for a few rounds before climbing out to attack.
- **Warlord.** When he dies all clay figures go inert. He can be shot from the door; a Major Hit with DMG 4 kills.
- **Clay army**. Up to two soldiers attack each Near character. Fleeing is a DEX save; a fail gives the soldiers an immediate attack. No hope of winning unless a vulnerability is found (water).
- **Crystals:** The crystals in the ceiling are the same as those in Area 6, When removed water from the Pool in Area 6 drains into Area 8.
- **Water.** If the clay army is submerged in water (see Area 6), each soldier takes 4 damage. THey take a further 1 hp per round until 0 hp when they disosolve into a mud puddle.
- **Treasure.** The Warlord's Globe.
- **Secret door.** Water can be seen draining through the wall in this location if any look here.

9: Treasure Vault

A spartan room: shelves, a camp chair, a pallet. A stone table lies within a crystal circle containing a pentacle. A withered body on the table. Face resembles that of the statue from Area 3 and the Warlord from Area 8. A concave hollow is carved into the table's head.

- **Treasure.** Brass rod, one half (150 coins). Copper brazier (10 coins). Fine weapons (4 usage dots): short sword, long bow with quiver, mace, spear, battle axe, dagger, hand axe. Light Armour. A tome only a Wizard can study (INT save in downtime, swap one spell).
- **Hollow.** If the Wizard's Globe is put in the hollow, the image of a goat-faced being appears: *"I have waited a long time for someone to take the warlord's place. His astral voyage was cut short before he could rekindle the spark of his mortal coil. I am still in need of an ally on your world. Fill this copper brazier with wood from a dryad's tree and ignite it with the spark of a living fire. The blaze will reveal the location of the other half of the rulership rod. Find that for me, and you shall be rewarded."* Then the globe dims to mere crystal.